ST JOSEPH'S INSTITUTION INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

"Enter to Learn, Leave to Serve"

Term 1 Common Assessment 2

Year 9 History

Focus of assessment:

- Year 9 History Unit 2 - World War 1

Date of Assessment: Week beginning Monday 2nd November 2026

9A - Mr Weatherup - Wednesday 4th November 2026
9B - Mr Weatherup - Monday 2nd November 2026
9C - Mr Weatherup - Tuesday 3rd November 2026
9D - Mr Weatherup - Monday 2nd November 2026
9E - Mr Lawrence - Tuesday 3rd November 2026

Description of assessment

This will be a 40-minute written assessment covering the key knowledge and skills developed during the Causes of the First World War unit. The assessment will include key term definitions, knowledge questions, source-based questions and an extended written response using historical evidence to explain and evaluate the MAINS causes of the First World War.

Assessment objectives

- **Knowledge and Understanding:** Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the MAINS causes of the First World War and the key events, people and developments that increased tensions in Europe before 1914.
- **Source Analysis and Interpretation:** Use historical sources to identify relevant information and explain how it helps us understand the causes of the First World War.
- **Historical Explanation and Judgement:** Explain how different causes contributed to the outbreak of war and make a justified judgement about which cause was the most important.

Marking criteria

- Demonstrates accurate historical knowledge and understanding of the MAINS causes.
- Uses relevant historical facts, people and events to support answers.
- Identifies and interprets relevant information from historical sources.
- Explains how different factors increased tensions and contributed to the outbreak of war.
- Uses appropriate historical terminology.
- Develops clear, well-structured explanations and supports judgements with relevant evidence.

Skills being assessed and success criteria

- Recall and explain the five MAINS causes: Militarism, Alliance System, Imperialism, Nationalism and Significant Individuals.
- Demonstrate knowledge of key events and developments leading to the First World War.
- Identify and use relevant evidence from historical sources.
- Explain how and why tensions between European countries increased before 1914.
- Construct clear, developed historical explanations using evidence.
- Write a well-supported PEEL paragraph and justify a judgement about the most important cause of the First World War.

Suggested Revision Approaches

- Review the relevant History lessons, notes and resources on Google Classroom.
- Revise the five MAINS causes, ensuring you can define and explain each one, using key examples such as the arms race, European alliances, imperial competition, nationalism, the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand and the Blank Cheque.
- Test yourself on key historical knowledge, people, events and decisions without looking at your notes.
- Practise answering source-based questions and writing clear historical explanations using PEEL, supporting your ideas with accurate evidence and a justified judgement.
- Review the KS3 Humanities Toolkit, Humanities Exam Command Words and KS3 Humanities Practical Revision Tips resources on Google Classroom under Support Materials to help you prepare effectively.